

For the love of my life. The wind will never change on us.



My love,

At the time that I'm beginning to write this, you and I have been together for less than seven months. I often look back very fondly at the memories we've made together, and all of the moments and times that you have made special. The pages in this will not have any common theme besides you, and how special that you are to me. I wanted you to have a physical copy - besides the love notes I have given you - of my words and thoughts of you.

As a warning, I'm writing this as if I'm writing an actual book, but I am probably going to be less formal in the actual notes that I want to give you.

I hope this is something you'll enjoy. I love you so much.

Just a note: I know sometimes my words might not fully capture how deeply I feel for you, but know that my love for you grows with each passing day. You mean the world to me, and I can't wait to continue building our story together.

I'll be the first to admit that I am not a writer or a poet. I am not good at expressing my feelings, whether written or spoken. That doesn't mean that I don't want to try, though. I always want to try. Even if the words I say don't make sense, I want to try to always convey to you the depth of my feelings for you. You mean the world to me. The trying is effortless, as long as it is with you, or for you.

To start, I'll give you a copy of a letter I wrote for you while sitting in one of my classes. You have a picture of this letter, but I never actually gave it to you. I hadn't planned on showing you that letter; I'd wanted to give it to you instead, but that day was hard, and I wanted to be able to give you a reminder that I love you, even when I am difficult.

Some of what I write here will be things I've written before and never given you. Some of it will be things I write when I'm thinking of you or missing you. Some of it will be poems or songs that remind me of you.

Whatever it is, anything here is just you. Just for you, just about you. And us. About you and us.

Here goes, written on January 25th, 2024:

Mafer, my love, there is so much I want to say to you and share with you. The time we have spent together has been absolutely indescribable. You are the most lovely, sweet, and kind person I've ever met. You say you're not perfect, you say you're flawed. To me, everything about you is perfect. Everything I learn about you just proves this to me even more. There is nobody other than you.

When I picture my future, you are in it. I can't tell you what's going to happen. I can't promise everything will go well or that we won't have disagreements or that there won't be times we miscommunicate or get hurt. But what I *can* promise is that I will always try. Try to listen to you, try to improve, try to make you feel loved.

You're right. I am stubborn, and it isn't necessarily a good trait of mine. But it also means I don't change my mind easily, and I have my head, eyes, and mind set on you.

Another older one, from February 1st, 2024:

We've been together for almost half a year. The time has really flown. It feels like just yesterday that I was questioning and overthinking and hoping that you felt the same way that I did. Now we're here, and I almost can't believe it. I never knew that I could feel as happy and safe and loved as I do with you. You've made such an impact on me that I don't even think either of us fully grasp yet. I think about you all of the time. I miss you when we're not together. Everything that happens - both important and unimportant - I want you to be part of.

I know we've only been together for not even half a year yet, but you are all I want, and all I could ever want. I want to be with you, and I want you in my future. I don't think I'm very good at expressing my emotions, both good or bad, but I'm going to try my best to share everything.

I love you. I've never loved anyone the way I love you. I could be busy, I could be doing nothing, and I still think of you and wish you're with me. I want to share everything with you.

I miss you. I'm writing this while in class, while you're at work, and I miss you. I go to sleep missing you and wake up missing you even more. I want to do and be better so that I feel truly deserving of having you. You're incredible, and everything I could have ever wanted or asked for.

I love you. I just told you this, though the you that is reading this might not remember this moment: I don't know if I believe in multiple universes. I just know that, if they exist, and you and I both exist in them, then every single me will always fall in love with every single you. I think that my love for you is inevitable.

It's very often that I think about the fact that we met at the exact right time. You happened to me perfectly, if that makes any sense. We were friends at a time in which I maybe direly needed friendship, and over time, that changed. It wasn't ever forced, and it wasn't ever an unnatural step. It just happened.

I think I'm getting off track - the point is that I was always going to fall in love with you, even if I'd never planned on it, even if it wasn't on purpose. You are just so you, and I love everything I've come to learn about you. You make the world seem so much more beautiful and full. I'm writing this and I'm hearing birds chirp and I'm watching the breeze sway leaves in trees, and it all makes me think of you. You make the world this charming to me.

I can't thank you enough for it, really. I've always loved nature, but I think I'd forgotten to appreciate it before you and I became an us. Everything's so bright and warm and shining like it never did before.

Mafer, my love, my darling,

This is going to sound incredibly cheesy. I have no apologies for that. My love for you is genuine, and although expressing that love may come across funny or cheesy at times, it is well worth it.

Every morning, the sun rises, and I am reminded yet again of the light you bring into my life. I dream of your smile, of your laughter, of your happiness.

When I'm not with you, I miss you terribly. When I'm not with you, it's as if my body feels the distance from you. I ache. My hands yearn for the feeling of holding yours. When we're apart, the days feel almost endless, but just the thought of you makes everything worthwhile.

I am eternally grateful for having met you. I am even more grateful that I have the privilege of loving you, and of being loved by you in return. It is very often that I think back on the time we've spent together, both as lovers and as friends. You've brightened my life endlessly. There is nobody as lucky as I am in this world, or in this universe.

Loving you is the easiest thing that I've ever done. Nothing comes more easily, or as without effort. You are, and always will be, the love of my life.

My love,

It is at this point that I would like to explain that not everything in this book will be written by me. I'll include poems that I feel describe my feelings for you. I'll include songs that do the same. I am no poet. I am no writer. I will always try my best to explain how deep my love is for you, but sometimes, there are other, better methods of doing so.

This is one such example: This poem was written by Elizabeth Barrett Browning, it is titled Sonnet 43 - "How Do I Love Thee?"

How do I love thee? Let me count the ways.
I love thee to the depth and breadth and height
My soul can reach, when feeling out of sight
For the ends of being and ideal grace.
I love thee to the level of every day's
Most quiet need, by sun and candle-light.
I love thee freely, as men strive for right.
I love thee purely, as they turn from praise.
I love thee with the passion put to use
In my old griefs, and with my childhood's faith.
I love thee with a love I seemed to lose
With my lost saints. I love thee with the breath,
Smiles, tears, of all my life; and, if God choose,
I shall but love thee better after death.

Here is an interlude, a necessary one, I think.

My darling,

We've been having a lot of difficulties lately. You won't see this until later, but no matter what happens, I will always love you. I am always here for you, to uplift you, to support you, and, simply, to love you. No problem, no misunderstanding, no argument will ever change that.

You are the Eurydice to my Orpheus. My songbird. My soulmate. Always, for as long as you'll have me.

I have seen in my heart, my soul, and my mind, that I am here to stay. You are worth everything. A life with you is worth everything.

I love you. I always will. You are my love, and I will never tire of saying it, I will never tire of telling you. I'll tell you every single day for the rest of our lives how much I love you.

You are my companion, my confidant, my greatest joy. I never thought that I could be lucky enough to find my best friend and my soulmate in a single person, but I am so grateful to have had this very welcome surprise. Life with you has been a beautiful story so far. It has had its ups and downs, but I would never trade it for anything in the world.

You are my Eurydice. You're my muse, my inspiration, and the light that guides me through the worst of days. Just like Orpheus and Eurydice, our story was meant to be. We were destined to meet, destined to fall in love. Even without destiny, I know I would have fallen in love with you no matter what.

I very often dream of our future together, a life filled with happiness and love. You are my forever, and I am yours. Every moment with you is something I will treasure forever.

I believe in us together, more than anyone alone. I believe that with each other, we are stronger than we know. No matter what we face, we can get through together, I am sure of it.

Te amo, mi angel.

This poem is by E.E. Cummings. Please forgive the formatting, that's just how the poem itself was written. It is called "[i carry your heart with me(i carry it in]"

i carry your heart with me(i carry it in
my heart)i am never without it(anywhere
i go you go,my dear;and whatever is done
by only me is your doing,my darling)
i fear
no fate(for you are my fate,my sweet)i want
no world(for beautiful you are my world,my true)
and it's you are whatever a moon has always meant
and whatever a sun will always sing is you

here is the deepest secret nobody knows
(here is the root of the root and the bud of the bud
and the sky of the sky of a tree called life;which grows
higher than soul can hope or mind can hide)
and this is the wonder that's keeping the stars apart

i carry your heart(i carry it in my heart)

My love,

As I sit here, writing and thinking of you, I am just so overwhelmed with love and joy and gratitude. Your love is the greatest gift I have ever received, and it is honestly something that I never imagined I could ever have. A love like yours is treasured and appreciated.

You are my everything. You mean the absolute world to me.

I would love to say that our love is like the story of Orpheus and Eurydice (but without the tragedy). In you, I find my muse, my inspiration, the one who brings light and beauty into my world. Every moment with you is a song, even your name is like a melody that fills my heart with joy.

I am so very deeply in love with you. The love that I have for you is almost overwhelming in its sheer magnitude. I've never been this in love, I've never been so enamored by anyone before. The way that I love you is almost terrifying, except that I have faith that no matter how hard I fall, you will be there to catch me.

Maria Fernanda Duarte Chinchilla,

I have many promises to make to you. But first, I have to make note of what I *can't* promise you.

I can't promise you fair sky above
I can't promise you kind road below

But I'll always walk beside you love, any way the wind blows.

I promise to love you always, to stand by your side through everything. The ups and downs, the happy, the sad, the boring. There is absolutely nothing that can change that I am yours, that I will walk beside you.

You are my forever, and I am yours. My love for you is eternal. I am yours, for as long as you will have me. Actually, I'll be yours even beyond that. No matter what, I'm yours. The better way to put it is I'll be with you for as long as you'll have me. Regardless, I will always be in love with you, and nothing can change that you are my soulmate.

You know, I've always been afraid of the future. It utterly terrifies me. I don't know what is going to happen, and there is so much out of my control.

That probably seems like a much darker tone and theme than the rest of the other letters have been, but I have a point, I promise.

So yeah, I was terrified of the future. I think a part of me still is, but I also find an immense comfort in picturing you in my future. You are someone that I truly imagine my life with; I want my future, and I want it with you.

I want to dance with you in the kitchen while we cook, I want to (badly) sing cheesy love songs to you. I want to wake up next to you in the mornings and hold you while we fall asleep. I want to do even the most mundane tasks with you. Grocery shopping was not enjoyable before you. I am sure taxes won't be fun either, but with you by my side, everything is colorful and bright and I don't think I've ever been this excited for a future before. It's you. You make everything so much better.

You're an angel. You're the love of my life. You are my favorite person, and my very best friend. God, I am so in love with you.

I think it is time for another poem interlude.

This one is in French. Because French is romantic (even though it has so many extra letters in words even though they don't use them - did you know bird in French is oiseau and it is pronounced "wuhz-oh." That's insane and I hate it. But French is supposed to be romantic and I like this poem.

Paul Éluard - "La Courbe de tes Yeux"

La courbe de tes yeux fait le tour de mon coeur,
Un rond de danse et de douceur,
Auréole du temps, berceau nocturne et sûr,
Et si je ne sais plus tout ce que j'ai vécu
C'est que tes yeux ne m'ont pas toujours vu.
Feuilles de jour et mousse de rosée,
Roseaux du vent, sourires parfumés,
Ailes couvrant le monde de lumière,
Bateaux chargés du ciel et de la mer,
Chasseurs des bruits et sources de couleurs,
Parfums éclos d'une couvée d'aurores
Qui gît toujours sur la paille des astres,
Comme le jour dépend de l'innocence
Le monde entier dépend de tes yeux purs
Et tout mon sang coule dans leurs regards.

Since my girlfriend does not know French and there is absolutely no reason for you to Google anything when I am writing this book myself, I will also provide an English translation for the poem.

Consider this French poem interlude part two.

The Curve Of Your Eyes

The curve of your eyes circles my heart,
A circle of dance and sweetness,
Halo of time, nocturnal and sure cradle,
And if I don't know anymore all that I've been through
It's because your eyes haven't always seen me.
Leaves of day and foam of dew,
Reeds of the wind, fragrant smiles,
Wings covering the world of light,
Ships laden with sky and sea,
Hunters of noises and sources of colors,
Perfumes hatched from a brood of dawns
Who always lies on the straw of the stars,
As the day depends on innocence
The whole world depends on your pure eyes
And all my blood flows in their eyes.

I hope you like the poem. I am no poet myself, but all love poems remind me of you, so this is one of many that I am going to present to you.

I keep a list on my phone of the things that you love. To be loved is to be known, and I want to love and know you so very much. You keep a list on your phone of the things that I love, too. Because you're an angel. And I am so in love with you.

You know, in this past semester (Spring 2024, just an FYI because you'll be getting this right around the Fall 2024 semester time), I spent so much time in my classes doing nothing more than daydreaming about you and writing about you and thinking about you. You occupy my thoughts. You're my first thought in the morning, and my last thought at night. I wonder how you're doing, I wonder how your day is, I wonder and wonder and wonder.

It's truly a wonder (ha, see what I did there) how I didn't fail any of my classes. I just about never took any notes, almost 85% of what I have in my notebooks is just you. Mafer this, Mafer that, my love, my love, my love. (The other 15% in my notebook, if you're wondering, was just me writing out the 196 countries of the world in the pages to pass the time.)

There is just so much of my heart and brain that you're part of. This book is actually a bit scary because of just how much you're going to learn and see of what I feel about you. But I love you, so being scared is just about worth it, I think. I want you to feel loved.

Funny enough, on February 15, 2024, about six months into our relationship, I texted Kiana that I was going to marry you, and that I was completely sure of it. Of course, by that point you and I had already decided that we were going to marry each other, and I was already so sure of it, but that text to Kiana was the very first time I told anyone but you that I am going to marry you.

Which I am, by the way. I am going to marry you. No matter what we go through, as long as you'll have me, I am yours.

I just thought that was a fun little tidbit to tell you. I think you and I are very much meant to be, and I am not afraid to tell you or anyone else that. I've never loved like this, and I've never been loved like this, and I know it would be the regret of a lifetime to let this beautiful thing go. That's not me. I don't need to lose something to appreciate the beauty. You're it for me. I am actually very much afraid of losing you, and I do not need to rediscover that away from you, thank you very much.

I am stubborn. I know that, I am so very well aware of it. But my stubbornness also means that I am sticking with you. You're it for me. No problem or misunderstanding or miscommunication will ever change that for me.

Te amo. Te amo, te amo, te amo.

This is also going to be a sort of change of pace.

But wow. You're so gorgeous. Like, I mean, I already knew that, but sometimes I sit back and think about you and I'm taken aback by how I am dating the most beautiful person on this planet. And I know you're going to laugh when you read that and think "Sofia, you're so funny." But I have two things to say to that. One: you should always always call me by a pet name, thank you very much. Two: I'm not joking. You truly are the most beautiful person I've ever laid my eyes on.

Both inside and out, by the way. Physically, you're breathtaking, and stunning, and I am genuinely in awe every time I look at you. You're more than that, too. You're beautiful in the way you talk to your friends, in the way you care for your mom and brother. You're breathtaking in the way that you laugh and make jokes and in the way that you have the silliest reserve of TikTok audios stored in that beautiful brain of yours. You're stunning in the way that you argue and smile and do so much to make sure everyone around you is doing well.

I've truly never met anyone that's beautiful the way you are. Physically, mentally, emotionally, spiritually. You're just so beautiful. I will repeat it as many times as I need to, and as many times as you need to hear it to start believing it too.

I've never held much stock in soulmates, even though I may joke a lot about them. But I do think that you and I are meant to be. You are my soulmate, whether they exist or not. My heart and my soul have bonded to yours in a way that they can never bond to anyone else ever again.

You're my soulmate in the way you hold my hand, in the way our fingers interlock with each other in just the right fit. You're my soulmate in the way that we are like puzzle pieces when we hug and when we cuddle; we fit perfectly together. You're my soulmate in the way you kiss me. Your kiss, your hand in mine, your gaze on me, they're all that I crave. You're my soulmate in the way that you read me, in the way that you can tell when I am upset, in the way that you know what I am thinking and what I am going to say. You're my soulmate in the way that I don't even believe in soulmates, but you're mine regardless.

My love, you are everything I could ever want, everything I could ever think to ask for. Every love song is about you. Every beautiful thing in this world is meant for you.

You're my soulmate in the way that we choose to be soulmates. We were meant to be, but we also choose to be. We choose to stick together, we choose to work things out. We aren't together because of some divine forces, but because of us. That's why you're my soulmate.

On the topic of soulmates, another poem.

This one is The Path to My Soulmate by Valery Verselet

I step out onto the path.
It's my path
not yours, not his, not anyone's
but mine,
my path—
and no matter where I turn,
now matter how the winds blow,
no matter how many times the path branches,
it always leads me back to you,
because you are my inescapable destiny—

Oh, love is a word, a nice word,
but how can it convey what I feel for you.
Everything leads me to you.
Everything I do is for you.

If you were not there,
I would have nothing.

You are my inspiration,
always one step away—
some day you'll give in
and then I suppose
I'll let go of this mad obsession
and face the reality
that we sometimes get

just what we want.

But hear this,
I will be true to you,
always and forever,
because this I know:
you are my soulmate beau—

And because it follows onto the next page, I will include another poem. This one is much shorter.

A Short Soulmate Poem
by Emily Eclogue

A soulmate is a lover first
and then perhaps a friend
and then at times maybe a stranger
and or at other times an enemy,
but then again a friend,
and always there, family,
if not in blood, then in soul,
always by your side.

I love you. You are my soulmate, and I will love you forever. I plan to be by your side, always.

My love, my soul,

I genuinely think that the more time I spend with you, the more I grow to love you, which I honestly didn't even think was possible. It's as if - with every passing moment - you surpass the impossible. My heart was already yours, and yet, you keep capturing more of me.

All of me is yours. And I truly mean *all* of me. Every love song is about you, every love sonnet is meant for you, and everything that brings me joy and happiness is meant to be shared with you. I find myself waking up thinking about you, and going to bed thinking about you. There isn't a moment that passes through the day in which I am not thinking of you.

You occupy my mind, soul, and heart. You are my best friend, my muse, my soulmate, and my love, all in one. I have never had so much fun, or laughter, or joy, as I've had with you. Never in my life have I felt this way, at least, not before you. You've changed everything for me (in the very best way possible.)

I fear I must mention as often as possible that you are the love of my life. And by fear, I mean shamelessly admit. You're the love of my life. No fear or shame here.

My baby

You know, I've done a lot (and I mean a LOT) of rambling about how much I love you. Both in this book and outside of it. But I really cannot emphasize enough just how much I love you. It's like the stars in the sky were hung by you. There is no other way of putting it. It's as if, ever since we met, everything is about you, everything is for you. And I did not misspeak there; ever since we met, not even since we started dating. Even before we kissed, before I realized my feelings for you, the amount I thought about you was maybe even criminal.

On the note of "before realizing," I am pretty sure everyone around us realized before we did. Or at least, before I did. One very distinct memory is when I went to the pride festival in Wynwood back in June 2022 (a whole YEAR before we even kissed) and I got us matching "top" and "bottom" bracelets. (Spoiler: I would not have done that for any one of my non-romantic friends.) I was really really good at deluding myself for a long time, I think. Or maybe I knew all along how I felt but I didn't have the courage to speak it. Who knows? Maybe I do. Maybe I'm supposed to, but I don't. I just know that I love you, and I've loved you, and I will only continue to love you even more.

Who would've thought I would meet the love of my life at the tender age of 16? I have zero regrets. Te amo.

So this page is going to be less of a direct sort of love letter (but still a love letter) and more of just some rambling.

We met at the age of 16, as I mentioned in the last page. Sometimes just thinking about that blows my mind. At 16, I was an absolute idiot. I was so focused on the wrong things and was even more emotionally stunted then than I am now. At 16, I met you, and I had absolutely no idea how important you were going to be to me. I almost wish I could go back and show 16 year old Sofia that she would end up getting that love that she was desperately craving. To show 16 year old Sofia that all the hurt she's feeling and going to continue to feel is going to be worth it because at the end of the day, she's going to have the most wonderful person there to love and to be loved by.

I can't speak for 16 year old you, but 16 year old me would be delighted at everything you and I have accomplished together in the time we've been together. 16 year old Sofia was a bit insane back then, and she needed the love back then that I am getting from you now, and honestly, just thinking about that makes me emotional. You are the most healing person I've ever met. Being around you, being with you, talking to you, all of it, it's all healing. You have honestly changed my life in ways I never would have expected. You are my hope, and my love. You've proven too me that it is okay to love and hope and grow.

I am going to continue on the note of the past just because of how flabbergasted I am. We really met so incredibly young. I mean, we're still young, but wow. That's insane. We were babies at that age. To think that two years after meeting, we would become friends, and another two years after THAT, we would become lovers. Baby, we've known each other for basically a quarter of our lives! That's so much!

But it's also so little compared to the amount of time that I want to spend with you. I want a lifetime with you. More than that, actually. I want this life with you, and the next, and all the ones after that, too. I wish that reincarnation exists, just for the opportunity to find you, and keep finding and loving you. You make everything worth it.

25% of our lives is going to turn into so much more. I want to know you for even longer. Even now, less than a year together, I feel like I've known you even before we met (accidental reference this time, but very fitting I think).

To finish up the accidental reference: All I know's you're someone I have always known. (I'll skip some lines for romance.) I don't ever want to have to let you go.

I'm not planning on it either. I want you for forever, not anything temporary.

Okay AWAY from the past. At least for now. Actually, maybe not.

You know, when we hung out properly for the first time, I was so very charmed by you? Not even romantically, just in general. You always talk about how me and Cris got along, but I think I was honestly always drawn to you. You were the one I reached out to more, the one I always asked to see, the one I would always crave hugs from.

It's almost as if you were the person who I was missing from my life. I know it's hard for you to take a compliment, but my life began the day that you came in it.

(That's a reference to a song. It's not a very happy song, but I like the meaning of that specific part.)

It is true though. I do think you changed my life on that day we met. You were always so kind and nice and warm. The warmth stands out more than anything else. Warm, that's the best way to describe you. You welcomed me into your life, you welcomed me to visit you and spend time with you and welcomed affection (and returned it.)

Even now, you're the warmest person I've met. You're loving, and welcoming, and you feel so much like home to me. You feel more like home to me than my actual physical home does, I think.

I think on this page I am really going to take the time to talk about you.

You, my lover, are truly an angel. You are the epitome of love and warmth. I know you don't very much consider yourself to be the things I am going to say about you but - to keep it short and simple - you're wrong.

Every day, every moment, that I've been able to spend with you has been the best of my life. You are a treasure that anybody would be lucky to meet, much less know. You've been loving and gentle and caring in ways that people dream about; from the way you hold my hand, the way you kiss me, the way you wipe my tears after a long, hard day. Every single day I wake up looking forward to seeing messages from you, hearing your voice, seeing your beautiful smile, all of it all of it. You say you talk too much, but in my eyes, you don't talk enough. You could talk for hours, and it would all be completely enrapturing.

I really cannot explain enough to you just how much I could never get tired of you; you are the brightest part of my life, and I cannot seem to even get enough of you. You're my favorite person. Every part of you. There's nothing about you that I don't love.

This is a recurring theme of a lot of the letters, but you really have changed my life. I haven't been this happy in so long, and it is in large part because of you. You fill me with so much joy, happiness, and peace. Peace is a really big one. I know we've had a lot of struggles, but at the end of the day, you're my home, my love, and my soulmate. Being with you, that's peace.

That isn't to mean that being with you isn't fun. It is fun. You are fun. In fact, I've also never had as much fun either, not before meeting you. You and I have done so many new things together and have explored so many new things and it has been nothing short of absolute joy.

But what I mean is, I am so very much myself around you. That's the kind of peace you are to me. I hope that you've found that peace with me, too. I want you to be able to find that with me and find a home in me and feel loved by me the way you've made me feel loved.

If I've managed to make you feel loved even just a fraction of how you've made me feel, that's honestly a win. Obviously more is better but wow. You've just been such an angel that it feels hard to even try to measure up. You really are just so - I can't even put it into words. I would keyboard smash because that feels more like it, but that doesn't seem very appropriate in a book, so just try to picture it in your head please, baby.

This one might be a bit of a ramble, so bear with me, my love.

I was thinking a lot about what you represent to me. Of course, you're my best friend, you're my girlfriend, my soulmate, my love, but you're even more than all of that to me, too.

I don't know what better way than to just say it. You are love to me. Love is you, you are love. I don't know if that makes any sense, but to me it does. You are to me everything that love is.

I wrote out that sentence and my immediate thought was, "Hm. What *is* love?" And I am happy to report that dictionary.com is wrong. Their definition is:

a profoundly tender, passionate affection, often mingled with sexual desire, for another person: sexual passion or desire. active, self-giving concern for the well-being of others: a person toward whom love is felt; beloved person; sweetheart

Okay, yes, love is all of these things, but it is also much *more* than that. You are more than that and my feelings for you are more than that. When I say you are love, I mean that you are much much more.

Part of my problem with love is just how difficult it is to put into words. It is more than just a verb or an adjective or

a noun. Love is so much bigger than anyone can even try to narrow down.

Love is an emotion. Love is feeling happy and safe and all. It's an action. We love (verb), with physical and emotional and other actions, with kisses, hugs, talks. It is also a choice. We choose to love. We choose to give and receive love. We may not choose the object of our love, but we choose how we proceed with those feelings, which is part of what makes love what it is. But again, I can't even begin to explain how much MORE there is to love (for me).

I'll try to describe it at least from my own point of view.

Love is when I've had a long day or a long week or am in a bad mood and I am able to fall into your arms. Love is feeling so completely at home besides you. Love is knowing the weight of your lips on mine, the feeling of your hand in mine. Love is listening to you talk, knowing that it is my favorite part of every single day. Love is you tickling me and laughing even though you know exactly how I'll react. Love is you wiping my tears. Love is us fighting to be together peacefully. It's us holding each other after we've had a rough time.

It's just - everything to do with you. You are love. Every time I think of love, I think of you. But that's exactly why every "definition" of love will be wrong: they haven't met you. They haven't had the privilege of being able to fall in love with you.

Poem time!

It is a bit long, but I think it is very beautiful. This one is written by a poet named Frank O'Hara.

Having a Coke with You
is even more fun than going to San Sebastian, Irún,
Hendaye, Biarritz, Bayonne
or being sick to my stomach on the Travesera de Gracia in
Barcelona
partly because in your orange shirt you look like a better
happier St. Sebastian
partly because of my love for you, partly because of your
love for yoghurt
partly because of the fluorescent orange tulips around the
birches
partly because of the secrecy our smiles take on before
people and statuary
it is hard to believe when I'm with you that there can be
anything as still
as solemn as unpleasantly definitive as statuary when right
in front of it
in the warm New York 4 o'clock light we are drifting back
and forth
between each other like a tree breathing through its
spectacles

and the portrait show seems to have no faces in it at all, just
paint

you suddenly wonder why in the world anyone ever did
them

I look
at you and I would rather look at you than all the portraits
in the world
except possibly for the Polish Rider occasionally and
anyway it's in the Frick
which thank heavens you haven't gone to yet so we can go
together for the first time
and the fact that you move so beautifully more or less takes
care of Futurism
just as at home I never think of the Nude Descending a
Staircase or
at a rehearsal a single drawing of Leonardo or
Michelangelo that used to wow me
and what good does all the research of the Impressionists
do them
when they never got the right person to stand near the tree
when the sun sank
or for that matter Marino Marini when he didn't pick the
rider as carefully
as the horse
it seems they were all cheated of some
marvelous experience
which is not going to go wasted on me which is why I'm
telling you about it

Fun Fact: the name Maria is dated back to ancient Rome, and its meaning is “of the sea.”

I do have a reason for bringing this up but your full name isn’t just Maria so I’ll add in an extra fun fact. The name Fernanda means “fearless.”

So, there are actually two tidbits I would like to bring to your attention. Actually, I’ll only be writing one of them down, so let’s hope I don’t forget the other one. (When you read this, just remind me: “sea.” I’ll maybe remember. Maybe.)

The fun tidbit I *am* including is that Maribel means “star of the sea.” It’s a bit less fun once you realize that Maribel is derived from Maria (It’s the combination of Maria and Isabel - apparently, at least. I’m not sure if I actually trust the website I read that from.)

I thought this was super interesting when I read it. It just further adds to my proof that we were always meant to be. Even our names signal this; it’s like the stars aligned just for us, my love.

Since I know you’re going to ask and you’re probably already wondering, Sofia means wisdom. You don’t have to look it up, baby.

You know, you are the one and only person I have ever loved in this way. I've never felt this strongly for anyone before. I have never woken up in the mornings and gone to sleep in the night thinking about anyone the way I have with you.

Before you, I'd never known what it's like to miss someone so deeply when they're not around, to feel their absence as if a part of me is missing.

You're the first person who has become such a part of me. It's almost as if you're engrained now in every fiber of my being. I'm happy when you're happy, sad when you're sad, angry when you're angry.

I've never been so eager to share every little detail of my day, or so excited to hear about anyone else's. I've never felt such a strong pull to be close to someone, to hold them, to be held, and to know that in those moments, that everything is the way it should be, the way it was meant to be.

You're the first person who has made me believe in the kind of love that people write about in stories. I've never wanted to build a future with someone as much as I do with you. I've never been so certain that I've found my person, the one I want to spend the rest of my life loving, learning with, and growing alongside.

This is a bit of a cop-out in terms of paragraphing and spacing and all, but I am about to list out some of my FAVORITE things about you.

- Your smile might be the most beautiful sight I've ever been able to witness. (I am super super lucky.)
- I love all of your moles. All of them. And I love our little ritual that lets me kiss all of the ones in reach. Right cheek mole, the mole under your mouth, the three pairs on your left cheek, your lips, your pinky.
- I absolutely adore the birthmark you have on your hip. I love kissing it, I love seeing it, it's so gorgeous on you.
- Your silly silly little habits with me. Tickling me whenever you get the chance, blowing air into my mouth, yanking my socks off, all of them. Every moment with you is so precious to me, and I love all of the fun that we have together.
- Your passion is one of my favorite traits of yours. You get so into everything and you really give all of you into something you enjoy and it is just so beautiful and cute to witness.
- You are so very thoughtful and loving and caring. From the way you are with me (holding my hand everywhere, kissing me and holding me and loving me), to your actions and gestures (listening to music with me, asking me to join you in playing games, all of the letters you've written for me) to the way you are with others. You're so considerate of your

family and you do everything you can to take care of your mom and your brother and you're even super nice to your sister even when you don't have to be. You just have the biggest heart in anyone I've ever seen.

- Your love for dogs. Every time I hear a little gasp or I notice your attention has been caught on something when we're out together, I immediately wonder "where is the dog?" I love love love how much you love dogs. I love seeing how happy you are around dogs and how excited you get to see them and pet them. (On that note, I am super excited to be able to one day have a bunch of dogs with you. You're going to be the most wonderful parent to them, I already know it.)
- The way you sing quietly whenever a song you know is playing. I love when you sing. Your voice is so beautiful. Everything you do is beautiful to me, there really is no better way of putting it, but God, your singing is just incredible.
- I adore the way you get scared during paranormal horror movies. I love that you watch them knowing you're going to have a hard time sleeping, I love that you and your sister comfort each other when you're scared, I love the way you cover your eyes and turn away and still take little glances. I love it all, I love YOU so much.
- This one is a bit funnier but I love your fear of lizards and reptiles. Nothing is more you than that. I would never look at you and guess yeah that person

is afraid of lizards, but knowing you and knowing that fear is really like wow that IS so my girlfriend.

That honestly doesn't even scratch the surface of everything I love about you. The thing is that it is just so hard to quantify everything. How do I write that I love everything about you? How do I put into words that there isn't a part of you that I don't love and adore? If I had to list out everything I love about you, not only would we be here for forever, it would also just be impossible. I can't write that I love the way you kiss me, because there's no way to describe it. The way you make me feel, and the feelings you inspire in me, are all completely indescribable.

It's like trying to capture the stars in the sky or the warmth of the sun on a summer day. It's like trying to count all the grains of sand on a beach. There's a magic in the way you touch me, the way you look at me, that goes beyond anything words could ever convey.

You are my love and my soulmate. My best friend and my inspiration. You make me want to try to do the impossible, to try to capture the stars, to count the sand, to describe my love for you.

I once made a joke to you that your kisses are like fireworks to me, but honestly, it isn't a joke. You do make me feel that way. When you kiss me, when you hold my hand, even when you so much as look at me.

That last bit was a bit emotional for me. I get very very teary-eyed thinking about how much I love you, and how much you mean to me. So to lighten things up, another poem.

To My Valentine by Ogden Nash
More than a catbird hates a cat,
Or a criminal hates a clue,
Or the Axis hates the United States,
That's how much I love you.
I love you more than a duck can swim,
And more than a grapefruit squirts,
I love you more than gin rummy is a bore,
And more than a toothache hurts.
As a shipwrecked sailor hates the sea,
Or a juggler hates a shove,
As a hostess detests unexpected guests,
That's how much you I love.
I love you more than a wasp can sting,
And more than the subway jerks,
I love you as much as a beggar needs a crutch,
And more than a hangnail irks.
I swear to you by the stars above,
And below, if such there be,
As the High Court loathes perjurious oaths,
That's how you're loved by me.

I love you. With every piece of me that's left. I don't know what the future holds, or what our paths may lead us to, but I do know that I want everything with you. I want to marry you and adopt so many dogs and build a life with you. I want to wake up to you every morning and fall asleep next to you every night. I want to learn all of your quirks and habits, and I want to be there with you when you have nightmares. I want to share our happiest and saddest moments together. I want it all with you, nobody else but you.

I want you to show me all of your favorite shows, movies, books, and games. I want to be able to buy you all of your favorite snacks and foods and learn how to make jamaica the way that you like it. I want to cook for you, read to you, and laugh together over the silliest things. I want us to dance to old records, laugh until we cry, and cry until we laugh. You're the only one I've ever wanted this with. I'm so in love with you that every single little thing reminds me of you.

I want to build traditions with you (even if we never really quite figured out what we want our traditions to be.) I want to celebrate all the big moments with you - our birthdays, our anniversaries, holidays, all of them - but I also want the small moments with you, too. Nothing is insignificant to me, not if it has to do with you, my love.

I want to be the person you lean on when things get tough and the one you share your dreams with. I want to support you in everything you do, cheering you on for all of it and standing by your side through it all. I want to grow old with you, to build a future and a lifetime together with you.

You're my best friend, my partner, my love, and I really truly genuinely cannot imagine a future without you in it. Every day with you is a treasure to me, and I'm so grateful to have you in my life.

The truth is that my first proudest achievement was meeting you, and my second proudest achievement is being able to call you my love.

Above all, I really just want to thank you for being at my side through it all. We really have been through a lot together in this past year, but I would not change any of it for the world. And I really mean any of it. All of the fights, tears, all of it is worth it because all of it is with you. I would go through all of it again just to have the opportunity to be with you. You are the love of my life. You, this relationship, and the love we share are all worth the world to me. I love you. I love you more than I can ever even put into words. I am so irrevocably in love with you, and nothing could ever change that. I am with you through it all, no matter what.

Te amo.

You are so incredible. There are no better words to describe you. There is nobody as caring, as sweet, or as kind as you; you are, for lack of a better term, the epitome of greatness. To be poetic, you're Venus, Hathor, Bastet, Freyja—the embodiment of love and beauty. You are a white carnation, symbolic of loveliness. A yellow tulip and a variegated tulip are two flowers that describe you: sunshine in your smile and beautiful eyes. To describe the depth of my feelings for you, gardenia, daffodil, and, of course, lily of the valley.

I'm not sure if you've ever noticed, but language does not capture everything. There's a gap; there are things that can't be defined—feelings, thoughts, emotions, and such—that can't be described, categorized, or anything of the sort. The definitions of feelings are circular; the definition of happiness leads to joy, to contentment, to peace, back to happiness. My love, you, and the feelings you invoke, are what our language misses. There is no quantifiable way to describe my feelings for you, or the impact you've had on mine (and everyone else's) life. That being said, there are some ways of describing you. Not perfectly, as you are so wholly and genuinely indescribable.

I want you to be able to wake up and be, without a shadow of a doubt, truly happy. I want you to be free of all your worries and doubts and regrets. I want you to be able to do anything and everything you want without ever feeling the need to apologize or backtrack. There's nobody more deserving of this joy than you are.

And, in case you ever forget, which I sincerely hope you don't because it'll mean that I've failed to remind you, you are the love of my life. When you open this (hopefully on our anniversary, if it's not delivered late), just know that I love you. Wholeheartedly, genuinely, and with every fiber of my being.

It is super silly, but I really often think about this one quote from Psych that just reminds me of how I need to treat you. I've told you about this before but I do take it sort of seriously believe it or not.

It's advice that Henry gave to Shawn (Henry is Shawn's dad):

"First treat a woman like a person, then a princess, then a Greek goddess, then a person again."

I don't actually have a solid interpretation of what this means but I do try my very best to listen to Henry's words. I love you, and all I want is to make sure you're treated right and correctly. I want you to feel appreciated and supported and cared for, no matter what. I want you to feel safe and secure with me and in our relationship. Your feelings and your safety and security are the most important things to me, and all I want is for you to be happy. I really love you.

I used to have a bit of a thing for the meanings of flowers and fruits and everything. You got a hint of it on Page 42, but I am going to elaborate and dedicate certain flowers to you.

I told you that the gardenia, daffodil, and lily of the valley describe my feelings for you. The gardenia's meaning is "secret love." Although my love for you is no secret, I had feelings for you for much much longer than before we were together, so I felt like it was fitting. The daffodil has a meaning that I also thought fit really well, which is "unequaled love." There is not a single person on this earth or in this universe that I regard the same way I regard you. There is nothing and nobody that I love the way that I love you. My love for you is completely unequal to the love other people will receive.

The fun one is lily of the valley. We both well know that it's your favorite flower, so this holds an even more special meaning. It actually has two meanings but one of them is more of a super fun coincidence than anything else. The one that I thought applied to you and to our relationships is "sweetness." You are the sweetest person I've had the privilege of meeting and knowing, and every moment I've spent with you has been nothing short of sweet.

The super fun coincidence: lily of the valley has a second meaning. "Tears of the Virgin Mary." Tell me that isn't fun! We both know it is.

To continue on this fun little trend of flowers and their meanings, here are some more that I didn't include before.

Red tulips are a declaration of love and passion. I very much feel both love and passion for you, if you couldn't already tell. Baby's breath, which is a very common plant in wedding bouquets and stuff, means "everlasting love." My love for you is in fact very everlasting. Nothing could make me love you any less. Actually, instead, with every passing day I just love you more and more. It's a little insane how much I love you, really. Mafer, my love, my soul, you really are the love of my life.

Camellias are an interesting flower because they come in a few different colors, and colors assign different meanings to things. In this instance, the pink, red, and white Camellias all apply to you and to us. The pink means "longing for you," the red means "you're a flame in my heart," and the white is "you're adorable." I long for you, constantly. My heart aches when I'm not with you. I miss you when you're not near me. Also you ARE in fact absolutely adorable. From the way that you smile to the way that you talk and your mannerisms and everything. Everything everything everything about you is adorable and lovely and so perfect and beautiful.

I've said it in the beginning, and I've said it through the rest of these letters. I am going to repeat it, endlessly, until you realize the importance you hold in my life. Maria Fernanda Duarte Chinchilla, you are the love of my life. You are the person that people dream of meeting. You are the person that people beg to have a chance with. I know you're going to laugh and say that I am so funny, but I am so completely serious. You are a catch. You are a treasure. You are the most incredible person anybody could ever meet.

You are the Eurydice to my Orpheus, the person that brings me inspiration and drives me to move forward and keep doing right. I love you like I've loved no other. I have never been so sure of a future than the one we've pictured together. You have changed my life, and you've completely entwined my heart with yours.

You're not like anyone I've ever met. You make me feel alive, and it's worth so much more than you can even think of.

When the time comes for us, we are going to get married. We're going to have our happily ever after, and everything that we've worked so hard for will be ours. I am so excited to be on this journey with you, baby.

I would just love for you to know that, from the day we've met (and I don't mean five years ago, I mean from the day we actually took the time to get to know each other and hang out and everything), I've adored you. I've never craved anyone's hugs before meeting you. I've never begged for the chance to see or hang out with someone before you. You really have changed me in so many different ways. You mean the absolute world to me.

I can't tell you exactly when I realized I had feelings for you. I've mentioned this to you before, but I think that maybe the lines were always a little blurred for me. The way I held your hands, hugged you, kissed your cheek and your shoulder and your hands, none of it was ever just as friends, even if I didn't know or realize it. The way that I interacted with you, talked to you, treated you, was way beyond anything I would have ever done with a friend. That isn't to say that you weren't my friend. You were, and you still are. In fact, now even more so. You're my best friend AND the love of my life all in one.

Right now I'm just rambling a little I think. I've just been thinking back to before we started dating and realizing just how enamored by you I've always been. To craving your touch, to being jealous of dates you went on, to missing you uncontrollably, all of it. You've always been it for me. I am glad that everything has worked out for us, and I really would never want anything to have changed.

I have a very strong attachment to music. I think that music is one of the strongest mediums of expressing emotions, and it is my very favorite way of expressing my own. I am no songwriter, no musician, and no singer, but I am a person who feels everything very very deeply.

So, I tried my very best to compile a list of songs that remind me of you or of our relationship (spoiler: they're all love songs.)

Also, I am really really hoping that the Barnes and Noble printing doesn't mess up the scan code because I thought it would be really cute for you to be able to get to the playlist straight from the book instead of asking me for it.

At the time that I am adding this, there are around thirty songs on the playlist, but in all honesty, by the time you get the book, there will be a lot of changes. Some additions, some removals, but a lot of love involved in the process. It's all for you.

I'll walk beside you love, any way the wind blows.



And here it goes, my love, my Eurydice.

Ten thousand words. Fifty pages. A million different ways of trying to describe my love to you.

These are lyrics from Rent that I thought fit nicely: Five hundred twenty-five thousand, six hundred minutes. Five hundred twenty-five thousand moments so dear. Five hundred twenty-five thousand, six hundred minutes. How do you measure, measure a year?

In good mornings, good nights, soft kisses, soft touches. In hand holding, in long car drives, in many, many lego builds. In sleepovers and hugs and cuddles. In movie theaters, in lunch dates, in shared music. In dates, in fights, in tears, in love. So much love.

I have spent the past year, the past twelve months, the past three hundred sixty-five days, the past five hundred twenty-five thousand six hundred minutes, being absolutely lucky and privileged to be able to call you my girlfriend. You have changed me, you have changed my life.

You are the love of my life. My soulmate. My best friend. You are the person I am going to marry. Baby, we've made it to our first year anniversary. Here is to many, many more. I love you so much more than you can possibly imagine. I am with you every step of the way.

(Come home with me?)

So, this last page I am intentionally leaving blank so that I can actually hand-write a letter for you. But I would be remiss if I didn't include the actual word count of this book for you. In the last page, I said 10,000 words, but it's actually a solid 10,941 words. Te amo te amo te amo.